



OFFICIAL

Clerical Discharge Procedure

1. Scope

Site	Operational Area	Applicable to
Armada Health Service	Health Information Management Service	Clerical

2. Purpose

This procedure outlines the clerical, webPAS and health records processes for inpatient discharges.

The discharging clerk is responsible for accurately recording patient information in WebPAS at the time of discharge and ensuring the patients' medical record documents are promptly forwarded for scanning.

The webPAS process guides should be referred to when searching, updating and discharging patients on webPAS.

3. Procedure

- Clerk is **notified** of proposed patient discharge by nursing staff. This can be confirmed by checking EBM or the journey board.
- Clerk to retrieve discharge documentation for nursing to provide to the patient prior to leaving.
- Clerk to **process discharge in WebPAS** confirming with nursing staff:
 - **Time of Discharge** – for legal purposes this needs to accurately reflect the time patient left hospital or was deceased
 - **Discharge Location** – e.g. home, transfer to other hospital.
- Refer to [WebPAS Inpatient Discharge Guide](#)
- Refer to the Deceased Patient – Clerical Procedure for clerical processes associated with deceased patients.
- The end of bed file, loose filing and other documents related to the patient are to be prepared as per the pre-prepping procedure

3.1 Statistical Discharge (Care Type Change)

A statistical discharge occurs when the patient is not being discharged from care but is undergoing a change in care type (refer [Section 8](#)).

Before referencing this procedure document please ensure that you have the latest version from the [Policy Library](#) information hub page.

- Clerk is notified of a patient change of care type and expected time of care type change via the Episode of Care – Care Type Change Form.
- The Clerk ensures that:
 - care type change is not being requested on day of admission, day of discharge.
 - Only one care type change is recorded per day.
 - Refer to the [Admitted Patient Activity Data Business Rules 2025](#).
- Clerk to complete statistical discharge and admission on webPAS. [Refer to the Statistical Discharge and Readmission Guide](#) for information.
- If patient has changed to Palliative care type, then the Palliative Care Outcome Collaboration (PCOC) assessment score details must be entered in webPAS. Clerk to liaise with clinical staff to ensure this is completed.

3.2 Medically Cleared for Discharge (MCFD)

- MCFD is entered in WebPAS when the patient's Care Type is changing to Maintenance
- Mental Health patients do not require a change in care type to maintenance and can be deemed MCFD at any time during their mental health admission.
- Clerks are only to action MCFD upon receipt of a completed Episode of Care – Care Type Change Form.
- After completing the Statistical Discharge as per above enter the MCFD date and time, Primary Reason and if provided Secondary Reason.
- [Refer to webPAS Clerical Guide – Medically Cleared for Discharge \(MCFD\)](#)

4. Legislative context

The following documents are required to give effect to this procedure:

[Admitted Patient Activity Data Business Rules 2025](#)

5. Supporting information

The following documents support the implementation of this procedure:

[WebPAS Step by Step Reference Guide](#)

6. Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Compliance against this procedure will be monitored by the Health Information Systems Support Officer, Inpatient Clerical Coordinator and feedback provided to the clerical staff.

7. Relevant standards

National Safety and Quality Health Service (NSQHS) Standards (second edition):

Standard 1 – Action 1.16: The health service organisation has healthcare record systems that:

- Make the healthcare record available to clinicians at the point of care
- Support the workforce to maintain accurate and complete healthcare records
- Comply with security and privacy regulations

- d. Support systematic audit of clinical information
- e. Integrate multiple information systems, where they are used

Standard 6 – Action 6.4: The health service organisation has clinical communications processes to support effective communication when:

- Identification and procedure matching should occur
- All or part of a patient's care is transferred within the organisation, between multidisciplinary teams, between clinicians or between organisations, and on discharge.
- Critical information about a patient's care, including information on risks, on risks, emerges or changes

8. Glossary

The following definitions are relevant to this policy.

Term	Definition
Discharge	Discharge is the administrative process, by which a hospital records the cessation of treatment and/or care and/or accommodation of a patient, where the patient: • Is discharged to private accommodation or other residence (excludes patients on leave). • Is transferred to another hospital, medical service or other external medical care accommodation (excludes patients on leave). • Leaves against medical advice. • Fails to return from leave within seven days, or 21 days for patient admitted on an Involuntary Treatment Order under the <i>Mental Medical Act 2014</i> and are placed on leave has deceased.
Statistical separation/discharge	Statistical separation/discharge is an administrative process that completes an admitted patient episode of care when there is a documented change in the clinical intent of treatment (for example, from acute care to palliative care). For each statistical discharge, there must be a corresponding statistical admission.

9. Policy owner (relating to these procedures)

Enquiries relating to this procedure may be directed to:

Title: Manager
 Department: Health Information Management Service
 Email: AHS_HIMS_Manager@health.wa.gov.au

10. Review

This procedure will be reviewed and evaluated to ensure relevance and currency. At a minimum it will be reviewed within one (1) year after first issue and at least every three (3) years thereafter.

Version	Effective from	Effective to	Amendment(s)
V3	10 12 2025	10 12 2028	Full review, changes in processes and broken links updated

11. Authorisation

This procedure has been authorised and issued by

Authorised by	Michael Morton - Director Operations & Corporate Operations.
Authorisation date	09 12 2025
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